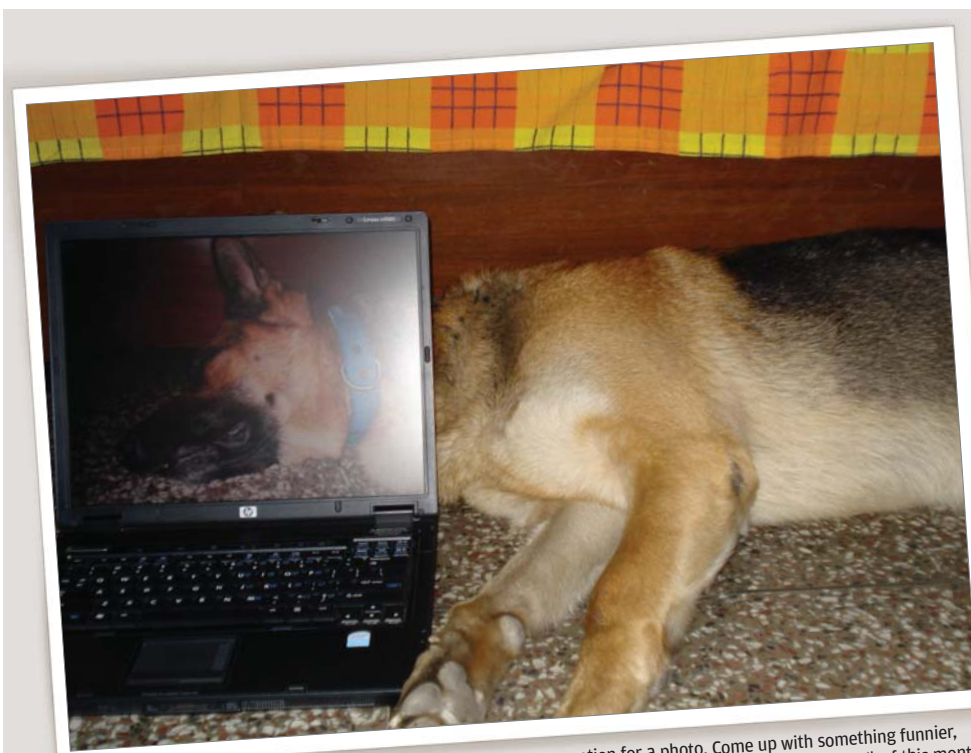




Photograph Amandeep Singh

Each month *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 20th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption

"Windows Siesta"

Last Month's Winner!

Ashwin Gupta,
Ashwin Gupta, Kanchili-532290
Srikakulam dt. A.P.
"SANI-AMIR-ZA"



E-mail your caption with the subject "Beat That", and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win

Beginning XML 4th Edition

by David Hunter,
Jeff Rafter, Joe Fawcett

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The first shipments of HCL-branded Classmate PCs are expected in August / September 2007.

Pilot tests for the Classmate PC have been conducted by Intel in certain schools in India since December 2006. Intel had initiated pilot programs by deploying Classmate PCs in three schools at Ghaziabad, Faridabad, and Bangalore.

Intel director for marketing (South Asia) John McClure has said that the Intel Development Center in Bangalore had extensively designed both the hardware and software for the Classmate PC, which is rugged and could withstand the using pattern of small children starting from class three.

The specifications of the Classmate PC seem good on paper and possibly otherwise: a 900 MHz Intel Mobile Processor, 256 MB DDR II RAM / 512 MB SO-DIMM, 1 GB / 2 GB NAND Flash memory, a 7-inch LCD screen, and sporting either Windows or a Linux OS. It

weighs 1.45 kg and has a six-cell Li-on battery, which is expected to last four hours. For connecting to the Internet, it uses Ethernet (10/100M) and Wi-Fi (802.11 b/g) connectivity. Pretty good for use by kids up to age 12; they don't need quad-cores!

The laptop carries a special educational feature set integrated for teacher-student and teacher-parent collaboration. This feature can be used as an innovative teaching aid. For instance, teachers can demonstrate diagrams and graphs from their laptops onto a projector / LCD TV screen, and using the Wi-Fi / Ethernet, the diagram or graph will simultaneously appear on the students' Classmate PCs.

HCL announced tie-ups with content providers and Education Service Providers (ESPs) to bundle their content with their HCL Classmate PCs. HCL will provide more educational content and learning solutions. The Original Equipment

Manufacturer Partners Wipro Infotech and Zenith Computers will also offer Classmate PCs shortly under their brand name.

With an estimated price of Rs 18,000 for the standalone model, the Classmate PC would be bundled with teaching aids, educational programs, and even training content for teachers to make the best of it. The entire system could be offered to schools on a monthly subscription basis, said Rajendra Kumar, executive vice president, HCL Infosystems. Also, parents can access feedback from the teachers.

An anti-theft security feature is included, which upon being enabled through the network works through digital certification. Also, audio / video and educational applications can function on it. McClure has said, "The initial target audience would be private schools, and then it will move to government-run programmes".

It would be interesting

to watch how Indian schools will make the best of this educational tool. The bottleneck of limited storage capacity (no hard disk, just 1 or 2 GB of Flash) can be augmented using network-based storage. But this depends upon the school's policy and the nature of usage for education.

SILLY NAME, BUT...

Low-cost, Green PC: All Good

An energy-efficient and environmentally-friendly computer has always been the ideal. Here's something along those lines: the Zonbu Computer, a \$99, eco-friendly little box-like PC, a subscription-based solution devised by Grégoire Gentil and Alain Rossmann. Gentil is the CEO of Zonbu; his last successful start-up, Twingo, was acquired by Cisco in 2004. Rossmann is an ex-Apple employee and